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FINANCE CONTROLS

Payment approval checklist

Seven controls that stop the expensive mistake: the wrong amount, the wrong account, the payment nobody can trace.

Seven controls before any payment leaves

Most large payment errors pass through an approval process. The approvers check the screen, not the payment. These controls move the check to what matters.

01 **Read the amount in words**

The approver reads the amount and currency out loud, in words, against the invoice. "Nine hundred thousand" is harder to miss than a row of zeros.

02 **Two people, two roles**

One person prepares the payment. A different person releases it. Nobody approves a payment they created.

03 **Second-day rule above your limit**

Above a limit you set (for example $50,000), the payment gets a second review on the next business day, not in the same hour.

04 **New beneficiary, second approver**

The first payment to any new account needs a second approver and a call-back to a number you already have on file.

05 **Match to the source documents**

Amount, currency, beneficiary name and payment reference match the invoice and the contract, character by character.

06 **Log every change to bank details**

Who asked, how it was verified, who approved, and when. A change without a log entry is not a change.

07 **Name the person who calls**

If a payment goes wrong, one named person contacts the payment provider within the hour, with the payment reference ready.

Before you press release

Print this page or copy it into your payment workflow.

- [ ] Amount read in words
- [ ] Beneficiary name matches contract
- [ ] Account unchanged since last payment
- [ ] Above limit: next-day review done
- [ ] Currency matches invoice
- [ ] Reference format agreed
- [ ] Second approver for new account
- [ ] Supporting documents attached

Prepared by _____

Approved by _____

Approval limit _____

Signals to stop and check

- Urgency: "today", "before the cut-off", "the CEO asked".
- Bank details changed in the same email as the invoice.
- Beneficiary country or currency differs from previous payments.
- An amount that ends in more zeros than usual.

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Running payments across borders?

Tell us your route: where the money comes from, where it goes and in which currencies. We will reply in writing with how the payment is checked at each stop and what to keep ready.

artpay.co/contact

ArtPay provides international payment infrastructure for business: accounts, corporate cards and cross-border settlements. This document is general information, not financial, legal or tax advice. Adapt every control to your company's own policies, limits and regulatory obligations.